



Tāhauranga Aotearoa

Regional Council 2025 Clipped

Metadata

File Identifier

2682d4a2-9679-1b4e-6e0b-7910c660760e

Language

Language Code

eng

Character Set

Character Set Code

utf8

Hierarchy Level

Scope Code

dataset

Hierarchy Level Name

dataset

Contact

Responsible Party

Individual Name

Geospatial Team

Organisation Name

Stats NZ

Contact Info

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geography@stats.govt.nz

Online Resource

Online Resource

Linkage

URL

<https://datafinder.stats.govt.nz/>

Role

Role Code

custodian

Date Stamp

Date

2024-12-02

Metadata Standard Name

ISO 19139 Geographic Information - Metadata - Implementation Specification

Metadata Standard Version

2007

Spatial Representation Info

Vector Spatial Representation

Topology Level Code

geometryOnly

Geometric Object Type Code

composite
Reference System Info
Reference System
Reference System Identifier
Identifier
Code
2193
Code Space
EPSG
Version
6.15(9.0.0)

Identification Info
Data Identification
Citation
Citation
Title
REGC2025_V1_00_Clippped
Date
Date
Presentation Form
Presentation Form Code
mapDigital

Abstract

This dataset is the definitive version of the annually released regional council boundaries as at 1 January 2025 as defined by the regional councils and/or Local Government Commission and maintained by Stats NZ, clipped to the coastline. This clipped version has been created for cartographic purposes and so does not fully represent the official full extent boundaries. This version contains 16 regional councils and area outside region (Chatham Islands Territory). The regional council is the top tier of local government in New Zealand. Regional councils are defined under schedule 2, part 1 of the Local Government Act 2002. They were established in November 1989 after the abolition of the 22 local government regions. Regional council boundaries must coincide with meshblock boundaries under schedule 3, clause 17 of the Local Government Act 2002. Regional council boundaries are based largely on water catchments, such as rivers, lakes, and harbours. The seaward boundary of the regions is the 12 mile (19.3km) New Zealand territorial limit. In determining regions, consideration was also given to regional communities of interest, natural resource management, land use planning, and environmental matters. There are 16 regions which cover every territorial authority in New Zealand, with the exception of the Chatham Islands Territory (included in 99 Area Outside Region). Five regions are administered as unitary authorities, which function as both regional council and territorial authority. These unitary authorities are Auckland Council, Nelson City Council, and Gisborne, Tasman, and Marlborough District Councils. The Chatham Islands Council also performs some of the functions of a regional council but is not strictly a unitary authority. Unitary authorities act as regional councils for legislative purposes. Regional councils are responsible for administering many environmental and transport matters, such as land transport planning and harbour navigation and safety. Some regional council boundaries are coterminous with territorial authority boundaries, but there are several exceptions. An example is Taupo District, which is geographically split between four regions, although most of its area falls within the Waikato Region. Where territorial authorities straddle regional council boundaries, the affected area is statistically defined by complete regional councils. In general, however, regional councils contain complete territorial authorities. Auckland Council unitary authority was formed in 2010, under the Local Government (Tamaki Makarau Reorganisation) Act 2009, replacing the Auckland Regional Council and seven territorial authorities. Regional councils are defined at meshblock level. Statistical area

1 and statistical area 2 geographies nest within regional council boundaries. The standard classification of regional council is a flat classification and contains 17 categories (including '99 Area Outside Region'). This clipped version has been created for cartographic purposes and so does not fully represent the official full extent boundaries. This high definition (HD) version is the most detailed geometry, suitable for use in GIS for geometric analysis operations and for the computation of areas, centroids and other metrics. The HD version is aligned to the LINZ cadastre. Names are provided with and without tohūtō/macrons. The column name for those without macrons is suffixed 'ascii'. Digital boundary data became freely available on 1 July 2007. To download geographic classifications in table formats such as CSV please use Ariā For more information please refer to the Statistical standard for geographic areas 2023. Contact: geography@stats.govt.nz

Purpose

This dataset is the definitive version of the annually released regional council boundaries as at 1 January 2025, as defined by the regional councils and/or Local Government Commission and maintained by Stats NZ, clipped to the coastline. This clipped version has been created for cartographic purposes and so does not fully represent the official full extent boundaries. This version contains 16 regional councils and area outside region (Chatham Islands Territory).

Credit

Stats NZ – Tatauranga Aotearoa

Point Of Contact

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Role

Role Code

custodian

Descriptive Keywords

Keywords

Keyword

regc

Keyword

REGC

Keyword

regional council

Keyword

Regional Council

Descriptive Keywords

	Keywords	
	Keyword	
	Downloadable Data	
	Resource Constraints	
	Constraints	
	Use Limitation	
	Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC BY 4.0)	
	Spatial Representation Type Code	
	vector	
	Language	
	Language Code	
	eng	
	Character Set	
	Character Set Code	
	utf8	
	Topic Category Code	
	boundaries	
	Microsoft Windows Server 2016 Technical Preview Version 10.0 (Build 19045) ;	
	Esri ArcGIS 13.1.3.41833	
	Extent	
	EX_Extent	
	Geographic Element	
	EX_Geographic Bounding Box	
	Extent Type Code	
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	Name	
	Enterprise Geodatabase Feature Class	
	Transfer Options	
	Digital Transfer Options	
	On Line	
	Online Resource	
	Linkage	
	URL	
	https://datafinder.stats.govt.nz/layer/120945-regional-council-2025-clipped/	
	Data Quality Info	
	DQ_Data Quality	
	Scope	
	DQ_Scope	
	Level	
	Scope Code	
	dataset	
	Lineage	
	LI_Lineage	
	Statement	
	Regional councils are based on the meshblock pattern. Non-alignment of meshblock and cadastral boundaries are one of a number of reasons for meshblock boundary adjustments. Other reasons include requests from local authorities, Local Government Commission, Electoral Representation Commission and to make census enumeration processes easier. From the meshblock pattern, higher geographies, including the regional council pattern, were dissolved using the dissolve tool in the Arc GIS suite. To derive the regional council boundaries clipped to the coastline, meshblock polygons were	

dissolved to exclude meshblocks with a land/water attribute of Inlet or Oceanic.

Metadata Constraints

Legal Constraints

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Restriction Code

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